

School Management System

User Guide

Version 1.0 | 2026
Prepared for the school administration and staff

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1. Getting Started

This School Management System runs entirely on your own computer — it does not require an internet connection to use day to day, and no data ever leaves your machine.

To start the application, double-click **SchoolManagementSystem.exe**. A small black window will open in the background — this is the app running. Leave it open while you work; closing it shuts the application down.

A few seconds after launching, your default web browser will open automatically and take you straight into the application.

Note: If your browser doesn't open automatically, open it yourself and go to **127.0.0.1:5000**.

2. First-Time Setup

The very first time the application is run, you'll see a one-time setup screen instead of a login page. This only happens once.

- **School name** — enter your school's full name. This will appear at the top of every page in the application from then on.
- **Admin username** and **Admin password** — choose the login you'll use as the administrator. Keep this safe; it has full access to the system.

Note: After submitting this form, you'll be sent to the login page and this setup screen will never appear again — even if the app is restarted.

3. Logging In

There are two kinds of accounts in this system:

- **Admin** — full access to every feature: students, classes, fees, payments, and reports.
- **Student/Parent accounts** — created automatically when the admin adds a student. These accounts can only view that one student's dues and payment history.

Note: A student/parent's username is always their registration number. Their default password is **user1234** until they change it.

4. Admin Guide: Dashboard

After logging in as admin, you land on the Dashboard. From here you can search for any student by name, registration number, CNIC, father's name, or phone number.

Search results link directly to an **Edit** page where you can update any of that student's information — name, father's name, gender, CNIC, phone number, registration number, or class.

5. Admin Guide: Classes

Before adding any students, set up at least one class. Go to **Classes** in the navigation bar.

- **Class name** — e.g. "Class 1", "Grade 5", etc.
- **Monthly fee** — the tuition amount charged to students in this class each month.
- **Order** — a number that determines the promotion sequence (see Section 13). Give your lowest class the smallest number and your most senior class the largest.

Note: You can add as many classes as you need, and each can have a different monthly fee.

6. Admin Guide: Students

Go to **Students** to add a new student. Fill in:

- Name, Father's name, Gender, CNIC, Phone number
- Registration number — this becomes the student's login username, so it must be unique.
- Class — select from the classes you've already created.
- Scholarship (optional) — choose Percentage or Fixed Amount and enter a value if this student is being granted a scholarship immediately.
- Charge admission fee / Charge security fee (checkboxes) — tick either one to immediately bill that student the school-wide admission or security fee amount (set in Fee Settings).

Note: Submitting this form automatically creates that student's login account (username = registration number, password = user1234).

7. Admin Guide: Manage Students

The **Manage Students** page is where you control each student's status:

- **Activate / Deactivate** — toggles whether a student is currently active. Deactivated students are excluded from monthly fee generation and bulk fee actions.
- **Revert** — only appears for students who were just promoted to the next class; clicking it moves them back to their previous class. Useful when a student is kept back a year.
- **Delete** — permanently removes a student, their login account, and all of their financial records. This cannot be undone.

Note: Delete is permanent. If you're unsure, use Deactivate instead — it can always be reversed.

8. Admin Guide: Fee Settings

Go to **Fee Settings** to configure school-wide fee amounts:

- Set the **Admission fee** and **Security fee** amounts, then click Save.
- **Apply admission/security fee to all students** — adds that fee as a new charge to every currently active student's dues in one click.
- **Add a misc. fee** — for anything else, like an examination fee. Give it a name and amount, and choose whether to apply it to one specific class or every student.

Note: Applying a fee is not automatically reversible — double-check the amount before clicking Apply, since it immediately adds that charge to every targeted student.

9. Admin Guide: Fees & Monthly Rollover

The **Fees** page shows every active student's current outstanding dues, filterable by class using the dropdown.

Move to next Month generates the next month's tuition charge for every active student automatically, based on their class's monthly fee (minus any active scholarship). It's safe to click even if some students already have that month's charge — it skips them.

You can also record a quick payment directly from this page using the amount box next to each student.

10. Admin Guide: Payments & Slips

The **Payments** page is the main place to record a payment and generate a receipt.

- Search for a student using any single field — registration number, name, father's name, CNIC, or phone number.
- Open their record to see their current dues, every charge ever billed to them, and their full payment history.
- Enter an amount and click **Record payment & generate slip** — this immediately reduces their dues and opens a printable receipt.
- Every slip shows the student's ID, name, class, amount paid, resulting balance, date, and who recorded it. Click **Print slip** to print or save it as a PDF from your browser.

Note: Dues work as a running balance: charges increase it, payments decrease it. Overpaying creates a credit that automatically offsets the next charge — you don't need to track this manually.

11. Admin Guide: Payment History

The **History** page lists every payment ever recorded across the whole school, most recent first. Each row links back to that payment's printable slip — useful for looking up an old receipt without knowing which student to search for.

12. Admin Guide: Reports

The **Reports** page gives a financial overview:

- This month's and this year's total collections, shown at the top.
- Total outstanding dues across the school — filterable by class using the dropdown.
- A full breakdown of collections by month and by year.

13. Admin Guide: Promoting Students to the Next Year

At the end of the school year, use **Move to next Year** (found on the Manage Students page). This moves every active student to the class with the next-higher Order number.

- Students in the senior-most class (no higher Order exists) are automatically **deactivated** instead — treated as having graduated.
- This action does **not** touch fees — it only changes class assignments.
- The recommended workflow: promote everyone first, then go through and use **Revert** on any specific students who need to repeat their current class, and only then run **Move to next Month** to generate the new year's fees at each student's final class.

14. Student / Parent Guide

Students and parents log in using the registration number as their username. The first time they log in, they'll be required to set a new password (the default is user1234).

Once logged in, the dashboard shows:

- A welcome message with the student's name.
- Their current total amount due, shown clearly at the top.
- A full history of every payment they've made, most recent first.

Note: Student/parent accounts are view-only. They cannot edit records, add students, or record payments — only the admin account can do that.

15. Changing Your Password

Any logged-in user — admin or student/parent — can change their own password from the **Change password** link in the navigation bar. This always requires entering the current password first, as a security measure.

Note: If a student/parent forgets their password, the admin should delete and re-add that student to reset their login to the default (user1234), or contact your developer for a direct-reset option if one has been added.

16. Troubleshooting & Tips

- **The app doesn't open in the browser automatically** — open your browser manually and go to 127.0.0.1:5000.
- **Windows shows a security warning when opening the .exe** — this is common for self-contained applications. Click "More info" then "Run anyway."
- **You can't add a student** — make sure at least one class has been created first, under the Classes page.
- **A student's dues look wrong** — remember dues are a running total: check their full charge and payment history on the Payments page to see exactly what was billed and paid.
- **The app looks unstyled or broken** — this usually means a file went missing from the installation folder. Reinstall using a fresh copy of the application folder.

17. Data Backup — Important

All of your school's data — every student, class, fee, and payment — is stored in a single file: **database/school.db**, located in the same folder as the application.

- Back up this file regularly (weekly is a reasonable minimum) by copying it to a USB drive or cloud storage.
- If this file is lost or deleted, all data is lost with it — there is no separate backup unless you create one yourself.
- Never rename or move this file while the application is running.

Note: This system is not actively maintained by its original developer after handover. For changes or support going forward, please contact your school's current system administrator.